Amusing Americana

'Huckleberry Finn' becomes tuneful role on the river

CUE

Cityside

TUESDAY

March 16, 1999

Niman Ranch loan

Meat producer may get help from Oakland

BUSINESS

Trouble in the city

San Francisco loses 2003 Super Bowl; Eddie DeBartolo expected to be fined $1 million

SPORTS

Mostly sunny
High: 57
Low: 44

Details in COFFEE BREAK

The Oakland Tribune

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Author of adventure

From the age of 15, when he became an Oakland oyster pirate, Jack London grabbed adventure with both hands on a typewriter to create California's golden age in literature.

During the next nine months, ANG Newspapers will profile the East Bay men and women who left their indelible mark on the 20th century. Our series begins with author Jack London.

EAST BAY FACES OF THE 20TH CENTURY

See story, **NEWS-8**

Report: MTBE water risks withheld

By Chris Bowman and Patrick Hoge
SCRIPPS McCLATCHY

SACRAMENTO — America's fuel industry knew about the risk to drinking water from MTBE years before domestic refineries more than doubled the chemical's volume in gasoline, but manufacturers marketed the product as an environmental improvement anyway.

In technical papers and conference presentations, environmental engineers for refineries and government regulators alike predicted that MTBE could become a lingering groundwater menace as its usage increased.

Sixteen years before MTBE-rich gasoline was approved for statewide use in California to combat air pollution, oil companies knew from their first experience with the fuel additive in New England how quickly methyl tertiary-butyl ether can migrate from leaking storage tanks to drinking water wells, company records and technical journals show.

At the time, the pollution specialists stressed that MTBE was in many ways more worrisome than gasoline's cancer-causing benzene.

"MTBE plumes are expected to move faster and further than benzene plumes emanating from a gasoline spill," three Shell researchers said in an internal 1992 paper. "Moreover, the solubility of MTBE is nearly 25 times that of benzene, and its concentration in gasoline will be approximately 10 times greater."

These papers have renewed importance today in California, where the spotlight on the controversy may turn on the industry.

Please see **Additive**, NEWS-9

Serbs facing a stark choice

Pressure on Milosevic to sign peace accord

By Deborah Seward
ASSOCIATED PRESS

PARIS — Ethnic Albanians delivered a clear "yes" Monday to an international peace plan for Kosovo, leaving Yugoslavia's president with a dilemma: Make peace or face NATO's wrath.

After more than five weeks of intense diplomatic pressure, the Kosovo Albanian delegation told international mediators Monday they were ready to sign the peace accord that gives them wide political autonomy but not the vote on independence they wanted.

"This is not an ideal solution, but peace in Kosovo has no price," said Hashim Thaci, the head of the ethnic Albanian delegation to Paris, where a second round of peace talks had opened only hours before.

He told reporters they hoped to sign the agreement today.

The French and British foreign ministers praised the decision and said it will heighten pressure on Yugoslav President Slobodan Milosevic to swallow the deal, which calls for NATO troops to enforce it.

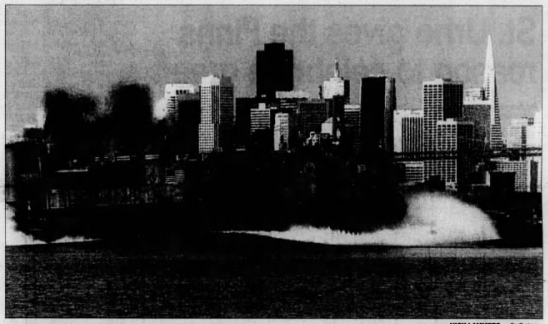
"The Albanian side has shown real courage in convincing the people that it is necessary to make a compromise. We need the Serb side to show the same courage," said British Foreign Secretary Robin Cook, co-chairman of the talks along with French Foreign Minister Hubert Vedrine.

The ethnic Albanians' earlier reluctance to sign the agreement led to the breakdown of the first round of talks last month and prevented NATO from carrying out threatened airstrikes if the Serbs failed to agree.

With new fighting breaking out across Kosovo, there are fears the conflict could lead to a

Please see **Kosovo**, NEWS-8

Marines storm the Bay



NICK LAMMERS — Staff photo

A Navy hovercraft loaded with Marines and their gear hits the shore at Seaplane Lagoon at Alameda Point as Urban Warrior training begins in the Bay Area.

Schedule

TODAY

FROM 8 A.M. to 4:30 p.m., Marines simulating a humanitarian operation at Oak Knoll will be asked to handle a breakdown of law and order staged by actors involved in the training.

FROM 9 A.M. to 11 a.m., reinforcements land at Alameda Point.

MARINES WILL test radio and navigation equipment amid San Francisco office towers during the day.

WEDNESDAY

MARINES WILL train at Oak Knoll from 8 a.m. to 4:30 p.m. The simulation will include increased civil chaos and confrontations with enemy fighters in an urban setting.

ACTORS PRETENDING to be political refugees will be evacuated from Concord Naval Weapons Station by Navy helicopters and flown to Oak Knoll.

MARINES AND their gear will be taken from Seaplane Landing back to their ships by the same amphibious carriers used on their arrival at Alameda Point.

THURSDAY

MARINES CONTINUE training in combat with "asymmetrical enemies," who will be played by members of the Alameda 23rd Marine Reserve Unit.

OPERATION URBAN Warrior concludes, and the remainder of the Marines and their equipment return to Alameda Point and their ships.

AN M1A1 TANK, a personnel carrier, assault vehicles and other equipment used during the training are set up for display on the USS Hornet Museum, a decommissioned aircraft carrier docked at Alameda Point.

FRIDAY THROUGH SUNDAY

AN EXPOSITION of Navy personnel, vessels and equipment will be held at Jack London Square, Piers 2 and 3 at Alameda Point, and Pier 35 in San Francisco. The exposition is called Forward From the Sea and will feature demonstrations of a Harrier jet that takes off vertically and a "parafoil" that enables a person to clandestinely fly into and out of areas. Admission to the exposition is free and it will be held from 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. daily. A destroyer, a missile cruiser, an aircraft carrier and the Navy's newest amphibious helicopter carrier will be open for tours during the exposition.

Protesters aim their messages at Marine and Navy personnel landing at Alameda Point to begin Urban Warrior training.

Protesters mobilize as games begin

By Glenn Chapman and Leslie Fulbright
STAFF WRITERS

ALAMEDA — Sea Stallion helicopters laden with Marines pounded across Seaplane Lagoon, awing spectators and drowning out the drumming and singing of protesters who gathered as urban combat training started here Monday.

A contingent of about 70 officers, some wearing riot gear, watched the well-mannered crowd and the well-executed Marine landing.

After helicopters landed next to the lagoon, Marines toting assault rifles and full packs marched down ramps lowered from the Stallion tails. Plumes of mist rose from the Bay, signaling the approach of armored hovercrafts carrying trucks, supplies and more Marines.

Roughly 100 demonstrators armed with banners, bullhorns, placards and giant paper mache figurines chanted, sang and gesticulated as Marines and their gear arrived.

Among the banners were the messages "Butterflies Not Bombs," "Money for education, not militarism," and "War is not a game."

One protester made his way out onto a rock wall that extends into the Bay at the edge of the lagoon. He was shepherded off the wall and taken to join the demonstrators outside the landing area.

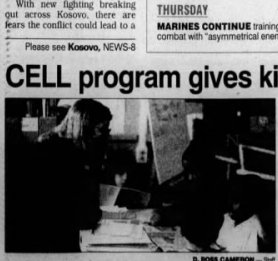
Military supporters and the simply curious lined the shore to watch Marines establish a beachhead at Alameda Point.

"These people forget that Marine officers offered them continued support during the earthquake," said Patricia Diers, waving her miniature American flag in the direction of the protesters. "I am an Alameda resident and I back this 100 percent.

"It is not about war, it's about safety. We have to be

Please see **Games**, NEWS-9

CELL program gives kids an early start



D. ROSS CAMERON — Staff

Joy Perkins, first-grade teacher at Shepherd Elementary School in Hayward, works on reading with (from left) Monique Rivera, 6, Fudarrel Maggitte, 6, Eric Bailey, 6, and Louis Doan, 7.

Harping on what's wrong with California's schools often seems easier than pointing out what's right with them. This series runs every Tuesday showing what some teachers and schools are doing to make things work.

By Carolyn R. Saraspi
STAFF WRITER

HAYWARD — At first glance, it looks like free time.

Children scattered all over classrooms use toys to point at words pasted on walls. Others play computer games, or sit in rocking chairs reading big picture books.

Closer examination reveals that the students at Shepherd Elementary School are engaged in a literacy program that helps them become indepen-

Please see **Reading**, NEWS-9

GOOD MORNING

NEWS		SPORTS	
LOTTERY	2	SCORES	5
BAY AREA	2	COFFEE BREAK	
STATE	4	LANDERS	2
NATION	5, 6	WEATHER	4
LOCAL		CUE	
CALENDAR	2	MOVIES	3
OBITUARIES	4	CLASSIFIEDS	
EDITORIAL	5	LEGALS	3
BUSINESS			
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Newest Rock inductees: Boss, Beatle, piano man

By David Bauder
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Three singers who dominated radio in the 1970s — Bruce Springsteen, Paul McCartney and Billy Joel — joined the Rock and Roll Hall of Fame on Monday along with Dusty Springfield, who died two weeks ago.

Elton John inducted Springfield, recalling how he joined her fan club and stuck her pictures on his bedroom wall.

"Every song she sang, she claimed as her own," said John.

Joel gave a long hug to fellow piano man Ray Charles, who inducted him. Joel said he learned

Please see **Hall**, NEWS-9